

Assignment: Software Testing and Quality Assurance

MCA 2nd Year | MCA211D

Submitted by: Srishti Malik

RollNo: 253028081

Q1. What is Software Testing? Explain its objectives and importance.

Definition

Software Testing is the process of executing a program or system with the intent of finding defects and evaluating whether it meets the specified requirements. It checks the actual behaviour of the software against the expected behaviour and provides information about the quality of the product. Testing can be **manual** (performed by a tester without tools) or **automated** (performed using tools and scripts).

Objectives of Software Testing

- **Detect defects:** to find errors, bugs and faults as early as possible, before the software reaches the user.
- **Verify requirements:** to confirm that the software does what the Software Requirement Specification (SRS) says it should do.
- **Build confidence:** to give stakeholders confidence that the software is reliable and ready for release.
- **Prevent defects:** to analyse the causes of defects so that similar mistakes are avoided in future work.
- **Ensure quality attributes:** to check functionality, performance, security, usability, compatibility and reliability.
- **Reduce risk:** to reduce the risk of failure in operation, which could cause financial loss or harm to users.
- **Support decision making:** to supply test results and metrics that help management decide whether to release the product.

Importance of Software Testing

- **Cost saving:** a defect found in the requirement or design phase is far cheaper to fix than one found after release.
- **Quality and reliability:** tested software behaves consistently and fails less often.
- **Security:** testing exposes vulnerabilities such as SQL injection and weak authentication, protecting data.
- **Customer satisfaction:** fewer failures lead to a better user experience and stronger trust in the product.
- **Compliance:** many domains (banking, healthcare, aviation) require proven testing to meet legal and industry standards.

- **Brand reputation:** a serious failure in production can damage a company's image and cause loss of business.

Q2. What is Software Quality Assurance (SQA)? Explain its role in software development.

Definition

Software Quality Assurance (SQA) is a systematic set of planned and preventive activities applied throughout the software development life cycle to ensure that the software processes and the resulting products conform to defined standards and requirements. SQA focuses on the **process** used to build software, with the aim of preventing defects rather than only finding them.

Role of SQA in Software Development

- **Defining and improving processes:** establishes development and testing procedures and improves them continuously.
- **Ensuring adherence to standards:** checks that the team follows standards such as ISO 9001, ISO/IEC 25010, IEEE 730 and CMMI practices.
- **Defect prevention:** uses reviews, inspections and audits at every phase to catch problems early.
- **Monitoring and measurement:** collects metrics such as defect density, defect removal efficiency and test coverage.
- **Planning and coordination:** prepares the SQA Plan, and coordinates with development, testing and management teams.
- **Reporting:** provides management with independent visibility into product and process quality.
- **Risk management:** identifies quality risks early and recommends corrective action.

Q3. Differentiate between Software Testing and Quality Assurance.

Basis	Software Testing	Quality Assurance
Meaning	Executing the software to find defects and validate behaviour.	A planned set of activities that ensures the process of development is correct.
Focus	Product oriented.	Process oriented.
Approach	Corrective / detective: finds defects that already exist.	Preventive: aims to stop defects from occurring.
Goal	To identify bugs and confirm requirements are met.	To improve the process so that quality is built in.
Scope	A part of the development life cycle (mostly after coding).	Covers the entire SDLC.
Performed by	Testers / test engineers.	QA team, QA engineers and process managers.

Basis	Software Testing	Quality Assurance
Activities	Test design, execution, defect reporting, regression.	Audits, reviews, standards, process definition, training.
Type	Considered a Quality Control activity.	Considered a management-level activity.
Example	Running test cases on a login page to check invalid passwords.	Defining a rule that every module must be peer-reviewed before testing.

Q4. Explain the major objectives of Software Quality Assurance.

1. **Ensure conformance to requirements:** the product must satisfy the functional and non-functional requirements agreed with the customer.
2. **Defect prevention:** identify and remove causes of defects through process control instead of depending only on detection.
3. **Compliance with standards:** ensure that recognised standards and organisational policies (ISO, IEEE, CMMI) are followed.
4. **Process improvement:** continuously measure, analyse and improve the software development processes.
5. **Early detection of problems:** find issues at requirement, design and code stage through reviews and inspections.
6. **Improve reliability and maintainability:** ensure software is dependable and easy to modify and support.
7. **Customer satisfaction:** deliver a product that meets expectations on time and within budget.
8. **Visibility and control:** give management accurate information on project status and product quality.
9. **Reduce cost and rework:** lower the cost of fixing defects late in the life cycle.

Q5. What is the difference between Quality Assurance (QA) and Quality Control (QC)?

Basis	Quality Assurance (QA)	Quality Control (QC)
Definition	Process-oriented activities that ensure quality is built into the product.	Product-oriented activities that verify the finished product meets quality standards.
Objective	Prevent defects.	Identify and correct defects.
Nature	Proactive.	Reactive.
Focus	Processes, methods, standards.	The actual product and its components.

Basis	Quality Assurance (QA)	Quality Control (QC)
Timing	Throughout the life cycle.	After a work product is produced (mainly testing phase).
Techniques	Audits, process definition, training, reviews, standards.	Testing, inspection, checkpoints, defect tracking.
Responsibility	Entire team, led by QA/process group.	Testing / QC team.
Example	Defining a coding standard and a review process.	Executing test cases and logging bugs found in a build.

Q6. Explain the role and responsibilities of a Software Quality Assurance Engineer.

A **Software Quality Assurance (SQA) Engineer** is responsible for making sure that software is developed and tested according to defined quality standards. The engineer monitors the process from requirements to release and acts as an independent guardian of quality.

Responsibilities

- **Review requirements and design documents** to check that they are clear, complete, testable and consistent.
- **Prepare the QA/test strategy and plan**, defining scope, resources, schedule, tools and risks.
- **Design test cases and test data** based on requirements, and maintain traceability between them.
- **Execute tests** (manual and automated): functional, regression, integration, performance, security and usability.
- **Log and track defects** using tools like JIRA or Bugzilla; report severity and priority; retest fixes.
- **Develop and maintain automation scripts** using tools such as Selenium, JUnit or TestNG.
- **Ensure process compliance** by conducting reviews, walkthroughs and audits, and checking adherence to standards.
- **Collect and analyse metrics** such as defect density, test coverage and defect leakage.
- **Perform root cause analysis** of defects and suggest process improvements.
- **Communicate with stakeholders**, giving clear status and quality reports, and contribute to release decisions (go/no-go).
- **Support continuous improvement** by sharing lessons learned and training team members.

Skills Required

Knowledge of SDLC and testing techniques, analytical and problem-solving ability, attention to detail, familiarity with test and defect-management tools, basic scripting/programming skills, and good communication.

Q7. Explain the relationship between Software Testing, Quality Assurance, and Quality Control.

Software Testing, Quality Assurance and Quality Control are closely related and together form the complete quality effort of an organisation, but they differ in scope.

- **Quality Assurance (QA)** is the broadest concept. It is a process-level, preventive activity covering the whole SDLC and establishes the standards, procedures and methods needed to produce quality software.
- **Quality Control (QC)** is a subset of the quality effort. It is product-level and detective; it checks that the built product meets the defined quality criteria, using reviews, inspections and testing.
- **Software Testing** is the most important technique of QC. It is the actual execution of the software to find defects and to validate the product.

Thus the relationship can be summarised as: **Software Testing $\subseteq$ Quality Control $\subseteq$ Quality Assurance** (testing is a part of QC, and QC is a part of the overall quality management under QA).

QA defines **how** work should be done, QC checks **whether** the outcome is right, and testing is **the way** of checking the software itself. The results of testing and QC (defect trends, metrics) are fed back to QA, which uses them to improve the process, and this creates a continuous cycle of quality improvement.

Q8. What are the different activities performed during Software Quality Assurance?

1. **Quality planning:** preparing the SQA Plan, defining quality goals, standards, metrics and responsibilities.
2. **Defining processes and standards:** establishing development, coding, documentation and testing procedures.
3. **Requirements and design reviews:** checking documents for completeness, clarity and testability.
4. **Technical reviews, walkthroughs and inspections:** peer examination of documents and code to find defects early.
5. **Testing activities:** planning and monitoring test design, execution and defect tracking.
6. **Configuration and change management:** controlling versions and changes so that the product remains consistent.
7. **Audits:** independent examination to confirm that processes and standards are actually followed.
8. **Measurement and metrics collection:** tracking defect density, defect removal efficiency, coverage, effort and schedule variance.
9. **Defect management and root cause analysis:** analysing why defects occurred and preventing them from reoccurring.
10. **Risk management:** identifying and mitigating risks that threaten quality.
11. **Training and mentoring:** making sure the team understands the standards and tools.

12. **Reporting and process improvement:** providing status to management and suggesting improvements.

Q9. Explain how Software Testing helps in improving software quality.

- **Finds and removes defects:** every defect found and fixed before release directly increases product quality.
- **Verifies functionality:** confirms that each feature works as specified in the requirements.
- **Checks non-functional quality:** performance, security, usability, compatibility and reliability testing ensure the software is fast, safe and easy to use.
- **Improves reliability:** stress and load testing reveal how the software behaves under heavy use so failures in real conditions are reduced.
- **Regression testing:** ensures that new changes do not break existing features.
- **Provides measurable information:** test coverage, pass/fail rates and defect trends show the actual quality level.
- **Reduces risk and cost:** finding defects early avoids expensive production failures and rework.
- **Feedback for improvement:** defect analysis shows weak areas in the process and helps prevent recurrence.
- **Builds user confidence:** a well-tested product leads to greater trust and satisfaction.

Q10. What is a Quality Management System (QMS)? Explain its importance in software development.

Definition

A **Quality Management System (QMS)** is a formalised system that documents the processes, procedures, responsibilities and resources needed to achieve quality objectives and meet customer requirements. In software organisations it is commonly based on **ISO 9001** and is often supported by models such as CMMI.

Key Elements of a QMS

- Quality policy and quality objectives.
- Documented processes, procedures and work instructions.
- Defined roles and responsibilities.
- Resource and training management.
- Monitoring, measurement, audits and management review.
- Corrective and preventive action and continual improvement.

Importance in Software Development

- **Consistency:** ensures every project follows the same proven processes, so results are predictable.
- **Customer focus:** helps meet and exceed customer requirements and expectations.

- **Reduced defects and rework:** systematic control lowers errors and saves cost.
- **Better decision making:** decisions are based on data and metrics.
- **Compliance:** helps to meet legal, regulatory and contractual requirements.
- **Continual improvement:** feedback and audits drive constant improvement of processes.
- **Credibility and competitiveness:** certification (e.g., ISO 9001) increases customer trust and business opportunities.
- **Clear accountability:** roles and responsibilities are well defined.